GPT VS. AN ASSISTANT

OpenAI defines a GPT as the assistant you can run and use within the ChatGPT interface. An assistant can only be consumed through the API and requires custom code in most cases. When you run an assistant, you're charged according to the model token usage and any special tools, including the Code Interpreter and files, whereas a GPT runs within ChatGPT and is covered by account costs.

The reason for creating a local version of the Playground was an exercise to demonstrate the code structure but also provide additional features listed here:

- *Actions (custom actions)*—Creating your own actions allows you to add any functionality you want to an assistant. As we'll see, the Playground makes it very easy to create your own actions quickly.
- *Code runner*—The API does come with a Code Interpreter, but it's relatively expensive ($.03 per run), doesn't allow you to install your modules, can't run code interactively, and runs slowly. The Playground will enable you to run Python code locally in an isolated virtual environment. While not as secure as pushing code out to Docker images, it does execute code windowed and out of process better than other platforms.
- *Transparency and logging*—The Playground provides for comprehensive capturing of logs and will even show how the assistant uses internal and external tools/actions. This can be an excellent way to see what the assistant is doing behind the scenes.

Each of these features is covered in more detail over the next few sections. We'll start with a look at using and consuming actions in the next section.

6.2.2 Using and building custom actions

Actions and tools are the building blocks that empower agents and assistants. Without access to tools, agents are functionless chatbots. The